

Part of Case	1	2	3	4
 <u>Understanding Situation</u>	- Does not confirm the Situation, Complication, or Question - Asks no relevant clarifying questions - Rushes in or freezes without processing the prompt	- Partially restates the problem but misses or muddles a key element - Any clarifying questions are generic or low-value	- Accurately confirms the Situation, Complication, and Question - Asks 1–2 relevant clarifying questions that fill genuine information gaps	- Restates the SCQ precisely, reframing the question in a way that sharpens scope - Asks targeted clarifying questions that signal analytical direction - Manages the transition with confidence and poise
 <u>Orienting with Framework</u>	- No framework offered, or ideas presented are irrelevant to the Question - No hypothesis - Takes >2 minutes	- Framework is generic with no clear connection to the client - Buckets are unclear to the interviewer - No clear hypothesis - Takes >2 minutes	2–3 buckets with 2 or more supporting points each, relating to the client - Presents framework clearly and concisely - Gives a hypothesis, but it is relatively unsupported - Takes 1–2 minutes	3–4 well-defined buckets, each with 2–3 supporting points specific to the client - Introduces buckets first, then supporting points - Pushes the case forward with a strong, relevant hypothesis - Takes 1-2 minute
 <u>Navigating Terrain</u>	Exhibits: Misreads or ignores exhibit; no interpretation beyond the surface Case Math: Makes significant errors or skips the math; no narration of approach Brainstorming: Lists a few vague ideas with no organizing structure	Exhibits: Reads data points literally but doesn't identify the most relevant ones or draw a business implication Case Math: Sets up the problem correctly but makes errors that change the answer; limited narration of steps Brainstorming: Groups ideas loosely but buckets overlap and ideas stay at a high level (e.g., "cut costs")	Exhibits: Identifies key data, states what the exhibit shows, and offers a reasonable "so what" Case Math: Narrates the approach clearly, rounds where appropriate, and arrives at the correct answer Brainstorming: Uses a clear mini-framework with 2–3 distinct buckets and specific ideas within each	Exhibits: Filters to most decision-relevant data, layers interpretation (what it is, what it says, what it means), synthesizes comparisons into takeaway that advances case Case Math: Frames problem up front, executes cleanly with intentional rounding and 80/20 shortcuts, narrates each step, sanity-checks result Brainstorming: Signals structure up front and lists concrete, actionable ideas
 <u>Pointing Toward Solution</u>	- No clear recommendation - No data cited to support the conclusion - Risks and next steps ignored	- Provides a vague or heavily hedged answer with loose references to analysis - Mentions a risk or next step but lacks substance	- Leads with a clear answer, supports it with relevant data or case math - Identifies a key risk with 1–2 logical next steps	- Leads with a confident, client-ready recommendation backed by the 2–3 strongest proof points - Names the most critical risk, mentions mitigation approach - Proposes prioritized, concrete next steps